

MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION

5 OBSERVER PAGES + 1 INTEGRATOR PAGE

Purpose: Give one page to each of five team members. Each observer watches the same video through one Session lens and writes down **specific evidence**. The sixth member acts as the integrator: listens to everyone, identifies the strongest connections, and helps build the final chart-paper answer.

How to use each observer page

- Do not write a plot summary. Record short, concrete moments: words, reactions, interruptions, pauses, gestures, assumptions, decisions.
- Separate **OBSERVATION** from **INTERPRETATION**. If unsure, write “may indicate...” rather than treating an inference as fact.
- Whenever possible, note the approximate timestamp or sequence: “opening / middle / after X says...”
- At the end of the clip, identify your **2–3 strongest observations** and the course concept each one supports.

Team allocation

Person	Page	Primary responsibility
1	Session 1	Meaning-making / interpretation / communication process
2	Session 2	Managerial communication / hierarchy / framing / change / media
3	Session 3	Verbal communication / word choice / framing / who gets the floor
4	Session 4	Non-verbal communication
5	Session 5	Listening / listening styles / Ladder of Inference
6	Integrator	Collect the five pages; find overlap; select strongest concepts/evidence; help structure final answer.

After the video: use **CONCEPT** → **EVIDENCE** → **EFFECT** → **IMPROVEMENT**. Do not try to use every theory. Use the theories that the evidence supports.

OBSERVER 1 — SESSION 1

COMMUNICATION FUNDAMENTALS / INTERPRETIVE MODEL

WHAT THIS PAGE IS FOR

Track **how meaning is created**. The slide says: "We don't receive meaning, we create meaning." Communication requires shared assumptions; people can also form perceptions of the other person's perception. ■filecite■turn9file2■L42-L51■

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- What exactly is communicated? Record the important words, action, tone or behaviour.
- What does the receiver appear to **interpret** it as?
- Is the apparent interpretation the same as the sender's apparent intention?
- What **assumptions** seem to sit underneath the interpretation?
- What is each person's **perception** of the other—and, where visible, their perception of the other person's perception?
- What response follows: emotion, agreement, resistance, silence, withdrawal, escalation, action?
- Is there **noise**? Session 1 identifies external, physiological and psychological noise. ■filecite■turn9file0■L10-L15■
- What is the **content** of the message, and what is its **relational** meaning? Session 1 explicitly distinguishes these dimensions. ■filecite■turn9file9■L248-L255■

FILL THIS WHILE WATCHING

Moment / timestamp	What was said/done? (OBSERVATION)	What meaning was created?	Assumption / perception behind it?	Effect / response

FINISH WITH: What is the strongest example of "same communication → different interpretation"? Why did the interpretation differ?

Communication competence check: Did the communicator understand the audience, adapt, show empathy/perspective-taking, and self-monitor? ■filecite■turn9file1■L25-L32■

OBSERVER 2 — SESSION 2

MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION / HIERARCHIES, CHANGE, FRAMING & MEDIA

WHAT THIS PAGE IS FOR

Track how communication works when there is **organizational hierarchy, change, uncertainty, or a choice of communication medium**. Session 2 covers change resistance, organizational/individual uncertainty, uncertainty-reduction strategies and management factors such as breaking a good-faith relationship. ■filecite■turn9file5■L102-L114■

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- **Top-down communication:** Is the goal employee **compliance** or genuine **support and acceptance**?
- **Feedback:** Is management disseminating an official view, or soliciting viewpoints and active participation?
- **Message sidedness:** Are only benefits communicated, or are realistic challenges/negatives also acknowledged?
- **Blanketed vs targeted:** Is everyone given the same message, or is the message adapted to different groups/interests? ■filecite■turn9file7■L181-L209■
- **Change resistance:** What rational/non-rational factors or uncertainties appear? Is the organization trying to reduce uncertainty?
- **Framing:** How is the situation defined and made credible? Look for gain/loss and contrast frames. ■filecite■turn10file8■L249-L256■
- **Media:** Is the communication medium rich or lean? Does it match an ambiguous/complex or routine/unambiguous task? Rich media can create data glut for routine tasks; lean media can create data starvation for ambiguous tasks. ■filecite■turn10file5■L186-L205■

FILL THIS WHILE WATCHING

Moment	Hierarchy / change issue	What is management trying to achieve?	Frame / message choice	Effect on acceptance / uncertainty

FINISH WITH: Is the organization achieving *compliance*, *support*, or both? What communication choice produced that outcome?

OBSERVER 3 — SESSION 3

VERBAL COMMUNICATION — CHOICE OF WORDS, FRAMING & SOCIAL STRUCTURE

WHAT THIS PAGE IS FOR

Track the **language itself** and the social structure around speaking. The slide identifies three underlying mechanisms: **Form, Frame, Floor**. Frame asks what wording presupposes/foregrounds; Floor asks who can enter, continue, redirect or challenge. ■filecite■turn9file8■L219-L228■

PART A — FRAMING / WORD CHOICE

- What exact word/label is used for the person, event, problem or decision?
- What does the wording make immediately **visible**?
- What does it put into the **background**?
- Who appears to act? Who benefits, suffers or disappears?
- What assumptions/values are hidden “under” the word?
- What alternative wording would redistribute attention? ■filecite■turn9file6■L124-L130■

PART B — WHO GETS LEGITIMACY ON THE FLOOR?

- **Invitation:** Is the person expected, permitted or actively invited to contribute?
- **Entry:** Can they secure a turn without being ignored or spoken over?
- **Continuity:** Can they finish the point, or are there interruptions/topic shifts?
- **Audibility:** Is language/register/volume/format intelligible and institutionally valued?
- **Credibility:** Who is treated as knowledgeable?
- **Uptake:** Does anyone respond to the actual claim, preserve attribution, or carry it into action?
- **Consequences:** What happens after someone speaks? ■filecite■turn9file6■L132-L150■

FILL THIS WHILE WATCHING

Moment / speaker	Exact word/phrase OR floor event	Frame / floor dimension	What is foregrounded/backgrounded?	Who gains/loses legitimacy or uptake?

FINISH WITH: Identify one phrase whose wording changed how the situation could be interpreted, OR one moment where someone's contribution failed to receive uptake.

OBSERVER 4 — SESSION 4

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

WHAT THIS PAGE IS FOR

You told me Session 4 covered non-verbal communication. The actual Session 4 slide deck was not among the files available to me, so this page is intentionally an **observation worksheet** for that topic rather than a reconstruction of slide-specific terminology.

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- **Facial expression:** Does the face support, contradict or complicate the spoken message?
 - **Eye behaviour:** Who looks at whom? Eye contact, avoidance, checking others, staring.
 - **Posture / gestures:** Leaning in/back, openness/closedness, pointing, restlessness, stillness.
 - **Space / seating:** Distance, position at the table, who occupies central/head space, who is physically peripheral.
 - **Voice / paralanguage:** Tone, pitch, pace, volume, emphasis, pauses.
 - **Silence:** What happens immediately before and after? Could it signal reflection, avoidance, discomfort, support, resistance or power?
 - **Incongruence:** Do words say one thing while delivery/body behaviour suggests something different?
 - **Change:** Does the non-verbal behaviour change when a particular person speaks, challenges, enters or leaves?
- IMPORTANT:** Do not assign a universal meaning to a gesture. Record the behaviour first, then interpret it in context.

FILL THIS WHILE WATCHING

Moment	Observable non-verbal behaviour	What was being said?	Possible meaning / relational effect	Confidence / alternative reading

FINISH WITH: What is the single strongest moment where non-verbal behaviour materially changes the meaning of the words?

OBSERVER 5 — SESSION 5

LISTENING — LISTENING LEVELS, STYLES & LADDER OF INFERENCE

WHAT THIS PAGE IS FOR

Track whether people are actually listening and how they respond. The session distinguishes mindful vs mindless listening and gives a hierarchy from not listening to listening to create shared meanings. ■filecite■turn10file0■L73-L78■ ■filecite■turn10file6■L217-L224■

WHAT TO WATCH OUT FOR

- **Listening level:** Not listening → waiting to speak → waiting to disagree → listening to understand → listening to create shared meanings.
- **Problematic behaviours:** not paying attention, pseudo-listening, listening but not hearing, rehearsing, interrupting, hearing what is expected, defensiveness, listening for disagreement. ■filecite■turn10file2■L140-L149■
- **Questioning:** Is the question clarifying, encouraging elaboration/discovery, or gathering facts? Is it a trap, condescending or sarcastic question?
- **Paraphrasing:** Does the person check whether both are on the same page?
- **Supporting:** Help, praise, agreement, diversion or minimizing?
- **Empathizing:** Does the response identify with the other person's perceptions/feelings?
- **Analyzing:** Is an alternative interpretation offered tentatively and helpfully, rather than as blame? ■filecite■turn10file1■L88-L129■
- **Listening barriers:** emotions, speaker's communication style, message content, perception. ■filecite■turn10file3■L159-L166■

LADDER OF INFERENCE — WATCH FOR THIS SEQUENCE

Observable data → **selected data** → **assumptions** → **conclusions** → **beliefs/action**. Look for a person moving quickly from what happened to what they think it means, then acting on that interpretation.

FILL THIS WHILE WATCHING

Moment	What did the person hear/observe?	Listening behaviour / style	Assumption or inference?	Effect

FINISH WITH: Where did listening fail—or where did someone create shared meaning? Where did someone climb the Ladder of Inference?

OBSERVER 6 — INTEGRATOR / FINAL ANSWER BUILDER

Your job is NOT to watch for one theory. You connect the five observer pages into one coherent explanation.

STEP 1 — IDENTIFY THE CENTRAL COMMUNICATION PROBLEM

Complete: “The central communication problem is _____ because _____.”

STEP 2 — COLLECT THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE FROM EACH OBSERVER

Session	Strongest observation	Concept	Why it matters
1 Meaning			
2 Managerial			
3 Verbal			
4 Non-verbal			
5 Listening			

STEP 3 — FIND CONNECTIONS

- Does **framing** influence **interpretation**?
- Does **power** determine whose interpretation receives **uptake**?
- Does **non-verbal behaviour** contradict or reinforce the verbal message?
- Does **poor listening** cause the Ladder of Inference to rise faster?
- Does **hierarchy/change/uncertainty** explain why the communication style is being used?

STEP 4 — CHOOSE ONLY 2–4 CONCEPTS FOR THE FINAL ANSWER

Pick the concepts with the strongest video evidence. A good answer does not need every Session. Use overlapping concepts when they explain one mechanism.

STEP 5 — WRITE EACH ANALYTICAL POINT AS C–E–E–I

C — Concept	Name the relevant course concept.
E — Evidence	Give the exact moment / line / observable behaviour.
E — Effect	Explain the mechanism: impact on meaning, trust, relationship, participation, acceptance or decision.
I — Improvement	Give a specific alternative behaviour and why it would improve the communication.

FINAL CHART-PAPER LAYOUT

Draw one central box at the top: **CENTRAL COMMUNICATION PROBLEM**. Under it, use 4–5 smaller boxes: **MEANING** | **WORDS/FRAMING** | **NON-VERBAL** | **LISTENING/INFERENCE** | **POWER/HIERARCHY**. At the bottom, connect them with arrows to **EFFECT / OUTCOME** and then **RECOMMENDATION**.

30-MINUTE FINAL WRITING: 0–3 map the scene • 3–7 pool evidence • 7–10 select 2–4 concepts • 10–24 write • 24–28 strengthen recommendations • 28–30 check evidence + mechanism + course terminology.

MASTER FORMULA: OBSERVE → INTERPRET → DIAGNOSE → EXPLAIN WITH 2–4 CONCEPTS → RECOMMEND → JUSTIFY

ONE-PAGE QUICK REFERENCE — TAKE THIS TO THE FRONT

Use this only after the five observers have filled their pages.

If you notice...	Look at...	Likely Session lens
Same words, different reactions	Interpretation, assumptions, perception, noise	1
Manager / organization under pressure	Compliance vs acceptance, uncertainty, framing, medium	2
Loaded words / competing descriptions	What wording foregrounds/backgrounds; words under words	3
Interruptions / ignored ideas / unequal participation	Invitation, entry, continuity, credibility, uptake	3
Tone / face / posture / space / silence	Does non-verbal behaviour reinforce or contradict words?	4
Defensiveness / rehearsing / waiting to disagree	Listening hierarchy and problematic listening behaviours	5
Jump from fact → motive → conclusion → action	Ladder of Inference	5

THE ANSWER SHOULD SOUND LIKE THIS:

"This illustrates **[concept]**. Specifically, **[observable evidence]**. This appears to affect **[meaning/relationship/power/decision]** because **[mechanism]**. A more competent approach would be **[specific behaviour]**, which could **[expected improvement]**."

DO NOT: retell the movie • list theories without evidence • assume intentions you cannot observe • say "communicate better" without specifying how • force all five Sessions into one answer.

DO: quote/describe specific moments • distinguish observation from inference • explain the mechanism • connect multiple concepts when they reinforce one another • make recommendations specific and feasible.